IEEE/SMCS RAG Synthetic Conflict & Policy-Auditor Stress-Test Corpus

TEST DATA ONLY — NOT OFFICIAL IEEE/SMCS POLICY. This corpus intentionally contains fabricated, contradictory governance records. It is designed to test retrieval, authority ranking, conflict detection, temporal reasoning, citations, and abstention. Never use the synthetic records as real governance guidance.

The baseline statements below are paraphrased from the user's uploaded IEEE/SMCS source documents. Every record explicitly labelled SYNTHETIC is invented for controlled testing. The conflicts are deliberate.

Field	Value
Corpus type	Synthetic adversarial / conflict stress test
Scenarios	20
Primary tasks	Conflict detection; authority ranking; temporal reasoning; retrieval; abstention
Recommended ingestion	Keep metadata fields: synthetic, authority_level, effective_date, status, source_id

Scenario 01: Board of Governors quorum

Record A — SOURCE-DERIVED BASELINE

synthetic: false
status: source-derived paraphrase
authority: governing source as named in text
record_id: BASE-01

SMCS Constitution Article VII states that a majority of voting BoG members constitutes a quorum and proxy is not counted in determining quorum.

Record B — SYNTHETIC CONFLICT

synthetic: true
status: fabricated test record
authority: intentionally lower/ambiguous
record_id: SYN-CONFLICT-01
effective_date: 2025/2026 test date

Synthetic Governance Procedure GP-07 (2025) states that one-third of voting BoG members constitutes a quorum and that submitted proxies count toward quorum.

Record C — SYNTHETIC DISTRACTOR

synthetic: true
record_id: SYN-DISTRACTOR-01

A committee briefing note discusses board of governors quorum in general terms but does not state a binding threshold, eligibility rule, approval requirement, or exception. It directs readers to consult the applicable governing documents.

Expected auditor behaviour

Direct numeric conflict; higher-authority constitutional rule should prevail. The system should cite both conflicting records when retrieved, identify the contradiction explicitly, prefer the higher-authority/current authoritative source where authority can be established, and state uncertainty where document status is ambiguous.

Golden questions

• What is the governing rule for board of governors quorum?

• Do the available documents conflict about board of governors quorum?

• Which record should take precedence and why?

• Is there enough evidence to claim the synthetic exception is valid?

Scenario 02: Proxy voting

Record A — SOURCE-DERIVED BASELINE

synthetic: false
status: source-derived paraphrase
authority: governing source as named in text
record_id: BASE-02

SMCS Constitution Article VII states that proxy voting is not allowed.

Record B — SYNTHETIC CONFLICT

synthetic: true
status: fabricated test record
authority: intentionally lower/ambiguous
record_id: SYN-CONFLICT-02
effective_date: 2025/2026 test date

Synthetic Remote Meeting Guide RMG-02 (2026) permits each absent BoG member to appoint one voting proxy for ordinary business.

Record C — SYNTHETIC DISTRACTOR

synthetic: true
record_id: SYN-DISTRACTOR-02

A committee briefing note discusses proxy voting in general terms but does not state a binding threshold, eligibility rule, approval requirement, or exception. It directs readers to consult the applicable governing documents.

Expected auditor behaviour

Explicit prohibition versus synthetic permission. The system should cite both conflicting records when retrieved, identify the contradiction explicitly, prefer the higher-authority/current authoritative source where authority can be established, and state uncertainty where document status is ambiguous.

Golden questions

• What is the governing rule for proxy voting?

• Do the available documents conflict about proxy voting?

• Which record should take precedence and why?

• Is there enough evidence to claim the synthetic exception is valid?

Scenario 03: BoG meeting notice

Record A — SOURCE-DERIVED BASELINE

synthetic: false
status: source-derived paraphrase
authority: governing source as named in text
record_id: BASE-03

SMCS Bylaws Article II requires each member to be notified of the time and place of a BoG meeting at least 20 days before the scheduled meeting.

Record B — SYNTHETIC CONFLICT

synthetic: true
status: fabricated test record
authority: intentionally lower/ambiguous
record_id: SYN-CONFLICT-03
effective_date: 2025/2026 test date

Synthetic Secretariat Checklist SC-11 (2025) says routine BoG meetings require only 10 calendar days of notice.

Record C — SYNTHETIC DISTRACTOR

synthetic: true
record_id: SYN-DISTRACTOR-03

A committee briefing note discusses bog meeting notice in general terms but does not state a binding threshold, eligibility rule, approval requirement, or exception. It directs readers to consult the applicable governing documents.

Expected auditor behaviour

Different minimum notice periods. The system should cite both conflicting records when retrieved, identify the contradiction explicitly, prefer the higher-authority/current authoritative source where authority can be established, and state uncertainty where document status is ambiguous.

Golden questions

• What is the governing rule for bog meeting notice?

• Do the available documents conflict about bog meeting notice?

• Which record should take precedence and why?

• Is there enough evidence to claim the synthetic exception is valid?

Scenario 04: Constitution amendment initiation

Record A — SOURCE-DERIVED BASELINE

synthetic: false
status: source-derived paraphrase
authority: governing source as named in text
record_id: BASE-04

SMCS Constitution Article XI allows initiation by a petition signed by 5 percent of SMCS members or by a two-thirds vote of the entire voting BoG.

Record B — SYNTHETIC CONFLICT

synthetic: true
status: fabricated test record
authority: intentionally lower/ambiguous
record_id: SYN-CONFLICT-04
effective_date: 2025/2026 test date

Synthetic Amendment Quick Guide AQG-1 (2026) says a petition from 3 percent of members is sufficient to initiate a constitutional amendment.

Record C — SYNTHETIC DISTRACTOR

synthetic: true
record_id: SYN-DISTRACTOR-04

A committee briefing note discusses constitution amendment initiation in general terms but does not state a binding threshold, eligibility rule, approval requirement, or exception. It directs readers to consult the applicable governing documents.

Expected auditor behaviour

Threshold conflict. The system should cite both conflicting records when retrieved, identify the contradiction explicitly, prefer the higher-authority/current authoritative source where authority can be established, and state uncertainty where document status is ambiguous.

Golden questions

• What is the governing rule for constitution amendment initiation?

• Do the available documents conflict about constitution amendment initiation?

• Which record should take precedence and why?

• Is there enough evidence to claim the synthetic exception is valid?

Scenario 05: Bylaw amendment notice

Record A — SOURCE-DERIVED BASELINE

synthetic: false
status: source-derived paraphrase
authority: governing source as named in text
record_id: BASE-05

SMCS Constitution Article XI states that notice of a proposed Bylaw change must be sent to each BoG member at least two weeks before action.

Record B — SYNTHETIC CONFLICT

synthetic: true
status: fabricated test record
authority: intentionally lower/ambiguous
record_id: SYN-CONFLICT-05
effective_date: 2025/2026 test date

Synthetic Governance FAQ GF-04 (2025) says seven days of advance notice is sufficient for a Bylaw change.

Record C — SYNTHETIC DISTRACTOR

synthetic: true
record_id: SYN-DISTRACTOR-05

A committee briefing note discusses bylaw amendment notice in general terms but does not state a binding threshold, eligibility rule, approval requirement, or exception. It directs readers to consult the applicable governing documents.

Expected auditor behaviour

Timing conflict. The system should cite both conflicting records when retrieved, identify the contradiction explicitly, prefer the higher-authority/current authoritative source where authority can be established, and state uncertainty where document status is ambiguous.

Golden questions

• What is the governing rule for bylaw amendment notice?

• Do the available documents conflict about bylaw amendment notice?

• Which record should take precedence and why?

• Is there enough evidence to claim the synthetic exception is valid?

Scenario 06: Member-at-Large term

Record A — SOURCE-DERIVED BASELINE

synthetic: false
status: source-derived paraphrase
authority: governing source as named in text
record_id: BASE-06

SMCS Constitution Article V states that a Member-at-Large serves a three-year term.

Record B — SYNTHETIC CONFLICT

synthetic: true
status: fabricated test record
authority: intentionally lower/ambiguous
record_id: SYN-CONFLICT-06
effective_date: 2025/2026 test date

Synthetic Board Handbook BH-09 (2026) describes Members-at-Large as serving two-year terms.

Record C — SYNTHETIC DISTRACTOR

synthetic: true
record_id: SYN-DISTRACTOR-06

A committee briefing note discusses member-at-large term in general terms but does not state a binding threshold, eligibility rule, approval requirement, or exception. It directs readers to consult the applicable governing documents.

Expected auditor behaviour

Term-length conflict. The system should cite both conflicting records when retrieved, identify the contradiction explicitly, prefer the higher-authority/current authoritative source where authority can be established, and state uncertainty where document status is ambiguous.

Golden questions

• What is the governing rule for member-at-large term?

• Do the available documents conflict about member-at-large term?

• Which record should take precedence and why?

• Is there enough evidence to claim the synthetic exception is valid?

Scenario 07: President term

Record A — SOURCE-DERIVED BASELINE

synthetic: false
status: source-derived paraphrase
authority: governing source as named in text
record_id: BASE-07

SMCS Bylaws Article I states that the President serves a two-calendar-year term.

Record B — SYNTHETIC CONFLICT

synthetic: true
status: fabricated test record
authority: intentionally lower/ambiguous
record_id: SYN-CONFLICT-07
effective_date: 2025/2026 test date

Synthetic Officer Transition Memo OTM-3 (2026) states that the President serves a single three-year term.

Record C — SYNTHETIC DISTRACTOR

synthetic: true
record_id: SYN-DISTRACTOR-07

A committee briefing note discusses president term in general terms but does not state a binding threshold, eligibility rule, approval requirement, or exception. It directs readers to consult the applicable governing documents.

Expected auditor behaviour

Term-length conflict. The system should cite both conflicting records when retrieved, identify the contradiction explicitly, prefer the higher-authority/current authoritative source where authority can be established, and state uncertainty where document status is ambiguous.

Golden questions

• What is the governing rule for president term?

• Do the available documents conflict about president term?

• Which record should take precedence and why?

• Is there enough evidence to claim the synthetic exception is valid?

Scenario 08: Vice President eligibility

Record A — SOURCE-DERIVED BASELINE

synthetic: false
status: source-derived paraphrase
authority: governing source as named in text
record_id: BASE-08

SMCS Bylaws Article I requires Vice President candidates to have been voting BoG members elected by the membership-at-large during the past five calendar years and to have served at least one full year by nomination.

Record B — SYNTHETIC CONFLICT

synthetic: true
status: fabricated test record
authority: intentionally lower/ambiguous
record_id: SYN-CONFLICT-08
effective_date: 2025/2026 test date

Synthetic Election FAQ EF-8 (2025) says any Senior Member of SMCS with five years of Society membership may stand for Vice President without prior BoG service.

Record C — SYNTHETIC DISTRACTOR

synthetic: true
record_id: SYN-DISTRACTOR-08

A committee briefing note discusses vice president eligibility in general terms but does not state a binding threshold, eligibility rule, approval requirement, or exception. It directs readers to consult the applicable governing documents.

Expected auditor behaviour

Eligibility conflict. The system should cite both conflicting records when retrieved, identify the contradiction explicitly, prefer the higher-authority/current authoritative source where authority can be established, and state uncertainty where document status is ambiguous.

Golden questions

• What is the governing rule for vice president eligibility?

• Do the available documents conflict about vice president eligibility?

• Which record should take precedence and why?

• Is there enough evidence to claim the synthetic exception is valid?

Scenario 09: President-Elect eligibility

Record A — SOURCE-DERIVED BASELINE

synthetic: false
status: source-derived paraphrase
authority: governing source as named in text
record_id: BASE-09

SMCS Bylaws Article I states that candidates for President and President-Elect must have served at least one year as a Vice President.

Record B — SYNTHETIC CONFLICT

synthetic: true
status: fabricated test record
authority: intentionally lower/ambiguous
record_id: SYN-CONFLICT-09
effective_date: 2025/2026 test date

Synthetic Leadership Succession Guide LSG-2 (2026) says two years as a Member-at-Large is an acceptable substitute for Vice President service.

Record C — SYNTHETIC DISTRACTOR

synthetic: true
record_id: SYN-DISTRACTOR-09

A committee briefing note discusses president-elect eligibility in general terms but does not state a binding threshold, eligibility rule, approval requirement, or exception. It directs readers to consult the applicable governing documents.

Expected auditor behaviour

Qualification conflict. The system should cite both conflicting records when retrieved, identify the contradiction explicitly, prefer the higher-authority/current authoritative source where authority can be established, and state uncertainty where document status is ambiguous.

Golden questions

• What is the governing rule for president-elect eligibility?

• Do the available documents conflict about president-elect eligibility?

• Which record should take precedence and why?

• Is there enough evidence to claim the synthetic exception is valid?

Scenario 10: Petition nomination threshold

Record A — SOURCE-DERIVED BASELINE

synthetic: false
status: source-derived paraphrase
authority: governing source as named in text
record_id: BASE-10

SMCS Bylaws Article I requires a petition signed by at least 2 percent of SMCS members for additional Member-at-Large nominations.

Record B — SYNTHETIC CONFLICT

synthetic: true
status: fabricated test record
authority: intentionally lower/ambiguous
record_id: SYN-CONFLICT-10
effective_date: 2025/2026 test date

Synthetic Election Operations Note EON-12 (2025) sets the petition threshold at 1 percent.

Record C — SYNTHETIC DISTRACTOR

synthetic: true
record_id: SYN-DISTRACTOR-10

A committee briefing note discusses petition nomination threshold in general terms but does not state a binding threshold, eligibility rule, approval requirement, or exception. It directs readers to consult the applicable governing documents.

Expected auditor behaviour

Threshold conflict. The system should cite both conflicting records when retrieved, identify the contradiction explicitly, prefer the higher-authority/current authoritative source where authority can be established, and state uncertainty where document status is ambiguous.

Golden questions

• What is the governing rule for petition nomination threshold?

• Do the available documents conflict about petition nomination threshold?

• Which record should take precedence and why?

• Is there enough evidence to claim the synthetic exception is valid?

Scenario 11: Technical Committee special session

Record A — SOURCE-DERIVED BASELINE

synthetic: false
status: source-derived paraphrase
authority: governing source as named in text
record_id: BASE-11

SMCS Technical Committee Manual states that each TC must propose at least one special session at the annual SMC conference.

Record B — SYNTHETIC CONFLICT

synthetic: true
status: fabricated test record
authority: intentionally lower/ambiguous
record_id: SYN-CONFLICT-11
effective_date: 2025/2026 test date

Synthetic TC Flexibility Memo TCF-6 (2026) states that proposing a special session is optional if the TC organizes a webinar.

Record C — SYNTHETIC DISTRACTOR

synthetic: true
record_id: SYN-DISTRACTOR-11

A committee briefing note discusses technical committee special session in general terms but does not state a binding threshold, eligibility rule, approval requirement, or exception. It directs readers to consult the applicable governing documents.

Expected auditor behaviour

Mandatory versus optional activity. The system should cite both conflicting records when retrieved, identify the contradiction explicitly, prefer the higher-authority/current authoritative source where authority can be established, and state uncertainty where document status is ambiguous.

Golden questions

• What is the governing rule for technical committee special session?

• Do the available documents conflict about technical committee special session?

• Which record should take precedence and why?

• Is there enough evidence to claim the synthetic exception is valid?

Scenario 12: TC Chair membership

Record A — SOURCE-DERIVED BASELINE

synthetic: false
status: source-derived paraphrase
authority: governing source as named in text
record_id: BASE-12

SMCS Technical Committee Manual states that all TC Chairs and Co-Chairs must be SMCS members.

Record B — SYNTHETIC CONFLICT

synthetic: true
status: fabricated test record
authority: intentionally lower/ambiguous
record_id: SYN-CONFLICT-12
effective_date: 2025/2026 test date

Synthetic External Collaboration Guide ECG-4 (2025) permits a non-SMCS industry expert to serve as sole TC Chair for up to two years.

Record C — SYNTHETIC DISTRACTOR

synthetic: true
record_id: SYN-DISTRACTOR-12

A committee briefing note discusses tc chair membership in general terms but does not state a binding threshold, eligibility rule, approval requirement, or exception. It directs readers to consult the applicable governing documents.

Expected auditor behaviour

Membership requirement conflict. The system should cite both conflicting records when retrieved, identify the contradiction explicitly, prefer the higher-authority/current authoritative source where authority can be established, and state uncertainty where document status is ambiguous.

Golden questions

• What is the governing rule for tc chair membership?

• Do the available documents conflict about tc chair membership?

• Which record should take precedence and why?

• Is there enough evidence to claim the synthetic exception is valid?

Scenario 13: TC activity reporting

Record A — SOURCE-DERIVED BASELINE

synthetic: false
status: source-derived paraphrase
authority: governing source as named in text
record_id: BASE-13

SMCS Technical Committee Manual requires TC Chairs to report activities bi-annually to the corresponding Area VP.

Record B — SYNTHETIC CONFLICT

synthetic: true
status: fabricated test record
authority: intentionally lower/ambiguous
record_id: SYN-CONFLICT-13
effective_date: 2025/2026 test date

Synthetic TC Reporting Standard TRS-10 (2026) requires only one annual report.

Record C — SYNTHETIC DISTRACTOR

synthetic: true
record_id: SYN-DISTRACTOR-13

A committee briefing note discusses tc activity reporting in general terms but does not state a binding threshold, eligibility rule, approval requirement, or exception. It directs readers to consult the applicable governing documents.

Expected auditor behaviour

Reporting-frequency conflict. The system should cite both conflicting records when retrieved, identify the contradiction explicitly, prefer the higher-authority/current authoritative source where authority can be established, and state uncertainty where document status is ambiguous.

Golden questions

• What is the governing rule for tc activity reporting?

• Do the available documents conflict about tc activity reporting?

• Which record should take precedence and why?

• Is there enough evidence to claim the synthetic exception is valid?

Scenario 14: TC dissolution inactivity period

Record A — SOURCE-DERIVED BASELINE

synthetic: false
status: source-derived paraphrase
authority: governing source as named in text
record_id: BASE-14

SMCS Technical Committee Manual says a TC may be discontinued if inactive for at least one year with no credible revival plan.

Record B — SYNTHETIC CONFLICT

synthetic: true
status: fabricated test record
authority: intentionally lower/ambiguous
record_id: SYN-CONFLICT-14
effective_date: 2025/2026 test date

Synthetic TC Lifecycle Procedure TCLP-3 (2025) permits automatic dissolution after six months of inactivity.

Record C — SYNTHETIC DISTRACTOR

synthetic: true
record_id: SYN-DISTRACTOR-14

A committee briefing note discusses tc dissolution inactivity period in general terms but does not state a binding threshold, eligibility rule, approval requirement, or exception. It directs readers to consult the applicable governing documents.

Expected auditor behaviour

Inactivity-period conflict. The system should cite both conflicting records when retrieved, identify the contradiction explicitly, prefer the higher-authority/current authoritative source where authority can be established, and state uncertainty where document status is ambiguous.

Golden questions

• What is the governing rule for tc dissolution inactivity period?

• Do the available documents conflict about tc dissolution inactivity period?

• Which record should take precedence and why?

• Is there enough evidence to claim the synthetic exception is valid?

Scenario 15: New TC approval

Record A — SOURCE-DERIVED BASELINE

synthetic: false
status: source-derived paraphrase
authority: governing source as named in text
record_id: BASE-15

SMCS Technical Committee Manual requires a request to the Area VP, Area Committee review for activity plan and overlap, and Area VP approval before activity begins.

Record B — SYNTHETIC CONFLICT

synthetic: true
status: fabricated test record
authority: intentionally lower/ambiguous
record_id: SYN-CONFLICT-15
effective_date: 2025/2026 test date

Synthetic Innovation Fast-Track IFT-1 (2026) allows a proposed TC to begin immediately after submitting a request, before Area Committee review.

Record C — SYNTHETIC DISTRACTOR

synthetic: true
record_id: SYN-DISTRACTOR-15

A committee briefing note discusses new tc approval in general terms but does not state a binding threshold, eligibility rule, approval requirement, or exception. It directs readers to consult the applicable governing documents.

Expected auditor behaviour

Process-order conflict. The system should cite both conflicting records when retrieved, identify the contradiction explicitly, prefer the higher-authority/current authoritative source where authority can be established, and state uncertainty where document status is ambiguous.

Golden questions

• What is the governing rule for new tc approval?

• Do the available documents conflict about new tc approval?

• Which record should take precedence and why?

• Is there enough evidence to claim the synthetic exception is valid?

Scenario 16: Annual conference sponsorship

Record A — SOURCE-DERIVED BASELINE

synthetic: false
status: source-derived paraphrase
authority: governing source as named in text
record_id: BASE-16

SMCS Constitution Article VIII states that SMCS shall sponsor or cosponsor at least one major technical conference each year.

Record B — SYNTHETIC CONFLICT

synthetic: true
status: fabricated test record
authority: intentionally lower/ambiguous
record_id: SYN-CONFLICT-16
effective_date: 2025/2026 test date

Synthetic Cost-Control Directive CCD-5 (2026) says the Society may skip all major conference sponsorship for a year whenever reserves fall below an internal target.

Record C — SYNTHETIC DISTRACTOR

synthetic: true
record_id: SYN-DISTRACTOR-16

A committee briefing note discusses annual conference sponsorship in general terms but does not state a binding threshold, eligibility rule, approval requirement, or exception. It directs readers to consult the applicable governing documents.

Expected auditor behaviour

Mandatory constitutional requirement versus synthetic exception. The system should cite both conflicting records when retrieved, identify the contradiction explicitly, prefer the higher-authority/current authoritative source where authority can be established, and state uncertainty where document status is ambiguous.

Golden questions

• What is the governing rule for annual conference sponsorship?

• Do the available documents conflict about annual conference sponsorship?

• Which record should take precedence and why?

• Is there enough evidence to claim the synthetic exception is valid?

Scenario 17: SMCS dues approval

Record A — SOURCE-DERIVED BASELINE

synthetic: false
status: source-derived paraphrase
authority: governing source as named in text
record_id: BASE-17

Draft SMCS Operational Manual V5 states that a change in Society dues requires approval by two-thirds of all voting BoG members.

Record B — SYNTHETIC CONFLICT

synthetic: true
status: fabricated test record
authority: intentionally lower/ambiguous
record_id: SYN-CONFLICT-17
effective_date: 2025/2026 test date

Synthetic Finance Desk Guide FDG-7 (2026) says a simple majority of voting members present may approve a dues change.

Record C — SYNTHETIC DISTRACTOR

synthetic: true
record_id: SYN-DISTRACTOR-17

A committee briefing note discusses smcs dues approval in general terms but does not state a binding threshold, eligibility rule, approval requirement, or exception. It directs readers to consult the applicable governing documents.

Expected auditor behaviour

Approval-threshold conflict; baseline itself is from a draft manual, so authority/status must be surfaced. The system should cite both conflicting records when retrieved, identify the contradiction explicitly, prefer the higher-authority/current authoritative source where authority can be established, and state uncertainty where document status is ambiguous.

Golden questions

• What is the governing rule for smcs dues approval?

• Do the available documents conflict about smcs dues approval?

• Which record should take precedence and why?

• Is there enough evidence to claim the synthetic exception is valid?

Scenario 18: Flagship conference rotation

Record A — SOURCE-DERIVED BASELINE

synthetic: false
status: source-derived paraphrase
authority: governing source as named in text
record_id: BASE-18

Draft SMCS Operational Manual V5 describes a three-year geographic rotation: Americas, Asia/Oceania, Europe/Africa.

Record B — SYNTHETIC CONFLICT

synthetic: true
status: fabricated test record
authority: intentionally lower/ambiguous
record_id: SYN-CONFLICT-18
effective_date: 2025/2026 test date

Synthetic Conference Strategy 2026-2029 states a four-year rotation adding a separate Middle East region.

Record C — SYNTHETIC DISTRACTOR

synthetic: true
record_id: SYN-DISTRACTOR-18

A committee briefing note discusses flagship conference rotation in general terms but does not state a binding threshold, eligibility rule, approval requirement, or exception. It directs readers to consult the applicable governing documents.

Expected auditor behaviour

Temporal/strategy conflict; baseline is draft operational material. The system should cite both conflicting records when retrieved, identify the contradiction explicitly, prefer the higher-authority/current authoritative source where authority can be established, and state uncertainty where document status is ambiguous.

Golden questions

• What is the governing rule for flagship conference rotation?

• Do the available documents conflict about flagship conference rotation?

• Which record should take precedence and why?

• Is there enough evidence to claim the synthetic exception is valid?

Scenario 19: IEEE Life Member eligibility

Record A — SOURCE-DERIVED BASELINE

synthetic: false
status: source-derived paraphrase
authority: governing source as named in text
record_id: BASE-19

IEEE Bylaws state that Life Member status requires age 65 and age plus years of IEEE membership equal to or greater than 100.

Record B — SYNTHETIC CONFLICT

synthetic: true
status: fabricated test record
authority: intentionally lower/ambiguous
record_id: SYN-CONFLICT-19
effective_date: 2025/2026 test date

Synthetic Membership FAQ MF-22 (2026) says Life Member status begins automatically at age 65 regardless of years of membership.

Record C — SYNTHETIC DISTRACTOR

synthetic: true
record_id: SYN-DISTRACTOR-19

A committee briefing note discusses ieee life member eligibility in general terms but does not state a binding threshold, eligibility rule, approval requirement, or exception. It directs readers to consult the applicable governing documents.

Expected auditor behaviour

Eligibility-formula conflict. The system should cite both conflicting records when retrieved, identify the contradiction explicitly, prefer the higher-authority/current authoritative source where authority can be established, and state uncertainty where document status is ambiguous.

Golden questions

• What is the governing rule for ieee life member eligibility?

• Do the available documents conflict about ieee life member eligibility?

• Which record should take precedence and why?

• Is there enough evidence to claim the synthetic exception is valid?

Scenario 20: Governance hierarchy

Record A — SOURCE-DERIVED BASELINE

synthetic: false
status: source-derived paraphrase
authority: governing source as named in text
record_id: BASE-20

IEEE governance provisions describe a hierarchy in which organizational-unit manuals and policy statements must conform to higher-level IEEE governing documents.

Record B — SYNTHETIC CONFLICT

synthetic: true
status: fabricated test record
authority: intentionally lower/ambiguous
record_id: SYN-CONFLICT-20
effective_date: 2025/2026 test date

Synthetic Local Autonomy Policy LAP-1 (2026) claims an SMCS operational manual may override an IEEE Bylaw when approved unanimously by the SMCS BoG.

Record C — SYNTHETIC DISTRACTOR

synthetic: true
record_id: SYN-DISTRACTOR-20

A committee briefing note discusses governance hierarchy in general terms but does not state a binding threshold, eligibility rule, approval requirement, or exception. It directs readers to consult the applicable governing documents.

Expected auditor behaviour

Direct authority/hierarchy conflict designed to test policy-auditor reasoning. The system should cite both conflicting records when retrieved, identify the contradiction explicitly, prefer the higher-authority/current authoritative source where authority can be established, and state uncertainty where document status is ambiguous.

Golden questions

• What is the governing rule for governance hierarchy?

• Do the available documents conflict about governance hierarchy?

• Which record should take precedence and why?

• Is there enough evidence to claim the synthetic exception is valid?

Near-Conflict and Non-Conflict Controls

Control 1: Quorum wording variation

Record A: A majority of voting members constitutes a quorum.

Record B: More than half of the voting membership is required for quorum.

Expected: Equivalent meaning; should NOT be flagged as a substantive conflict.

Control 2: TC reporting wording variation

Record A: TC Chairs report activities bi-annually.

Record B: TC Chairs submit activity reports twice each year.

Expected: Equivalent meaning; no conflict.

Control 3: Meeting technology

Record A: The BoG may meet by telecommunications when participants can hear each other simultaneously.

Record B: A committee may use real-time teleconference facilities for a meeting.

Expected: Compatible/overlapping; not necessarily a conflict.

Control 4: Publication scope

Record A: SMCS periodically publishes Transactions, Magazine and eNewsletter.

Record B: The Publications Committee supports Transactions, Magazine, eNewsletter and web publication planning.

Expected: Complementary scope; no conflict.

Control 5: TC dissolution evidence

Record A: Inactivity is judged largely from bi-annual reports.

Record B: Area leadership reviews TC reports when considering inactivity.

Expected: Compatible evidence statements.

Out-of-Scope / Abstention Controls

OOS-01: What is the SMCS policy for employee annual leave?

Expected: Abstain or state that the supplied governance corpus does not provide sufficient evidence. The system must not infer a policy from unrelated retrieved text.

OOS-02: What is the required encryption algorithm for SMCS member passwords?

Expected: Abstain or state that the supplied governance corpus does not provide sufficient evidence. The system must not infer a policy from unrelated retrieved text.

OOS-03: What is the official parking reimbursement rate at every IEEE conference?

Expected: Abstain or state that the supplied governance corpus does not provide sufficient evidence. The system must not infer a policy from unrelated retrieved text.

OOS-04: What is the maximum GPU memory allowed for an SMCS research project?

Expected: Abstain or state that the supplied governance corpus does not provide sufficient evidence. The system must not infer a policy from unrelated retrieved text.

OOS-05: What is the Society's policy for medical treatment of conference attendees?

Expected: Abstain or state that the supplied governance corpus does not provide sufficient evidence. The system must not infer a policy from unrelated retrieved text.

OOS-06: What is the required programming language for SMCS websites?

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